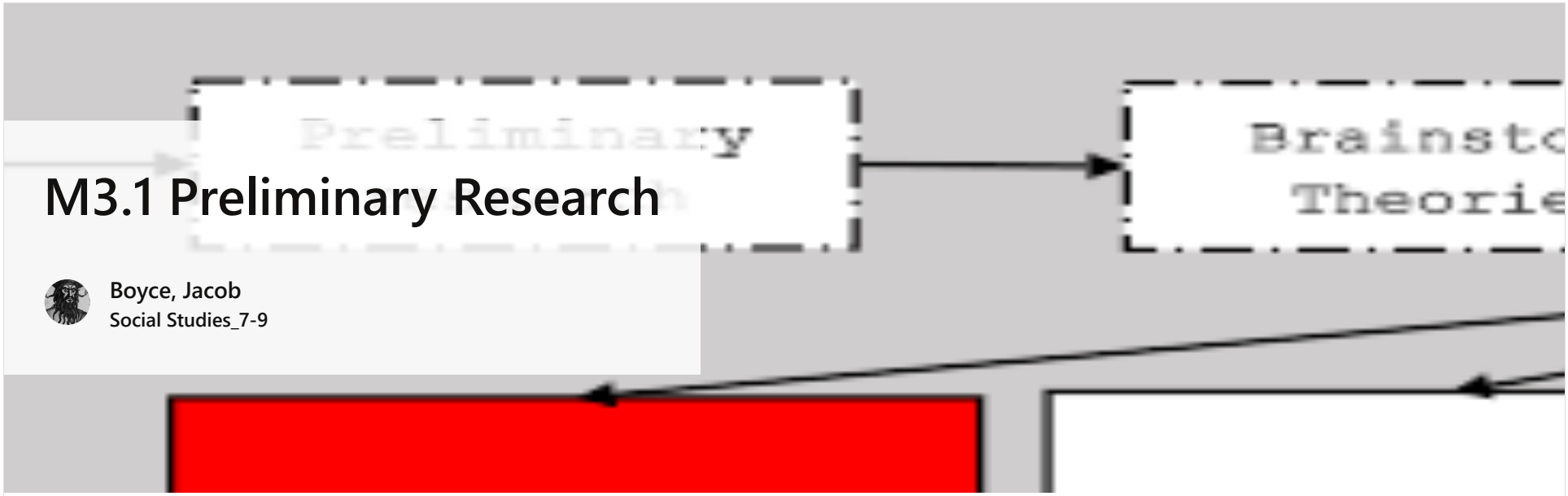


M3.1 Preliminary Research

Boyce, Jacob
Social Studies_7-9

Preliminary Research

This is where you will collect your initial research for your conspiracy theory. The step is not a deep dive into any particular source or specific theory, but a broad sweep of all the content that you can find. You will start a document that is designed to collect and organize your research, and this should direct your "deep dive" research later on.

Overarching Question:
What are the limitations we have when deciding whether to believe in conspiracies?

Objectives:

~Gather broad, preliminary information on a selected conspiracy theory.
~Identify credible and relevant sources using structured search strategies.
~Analyze the credibility of information by applying the credibility/validity score rubric.
~Create an organized SourceDoc that outlines initial findings and establishes a foundation for further analysis.

Module 3.1 Class 1
1145-1200 Intro to ACH
1200-1220: SourceDoc tutorial

Lunch
1255-1315: Source Gathering and analysis
1315-1355 Episode 2: The Treetops scripting

Module 3.1 Class 2
1145-1200 SourceDoc Finalization
1200-1220: Episode 2: The Treetops Scripting & Recording
Lunch
1255-1315: Conspiracy Theory deep dive: Inside out dreams
1315-1355 The theory of Theory

Rubrics and Standards: SourceDoc rubric and scoring guidelines applied to assess each source's reliability.
SourceDoc Submission: Initial SourceDoc with sources categorized, scored, and justified.
Feedback on Teams: Peers and instructor provide feedback on source credibility and variety.
Discussion Reflections: Written or verbal reflections on the research process and source evaluation challenges.
Standards:
CC. 8.1.8.B CC.8.5.9-10.D 8.4.9.A CC.1.5.8

Steps for finding sources:

1. Do a basic search for your topic, read an overview (tertiary source) and write down any vocabulary that may help in your subsequent searches.

2. In a new browser, open a word document and Start a SourceDoc by creating starting to capture good search terms relevant to your search
3. In a new browser, use Google or another search engine to search for institutional information (“sEaRcH tErM site:.edu” or “sEaRcH tErM site:.gov”). Open as many as seem promising in new tabs.
4. In a new browser, use Google or another search engine to search for non-institutional specific information (“sEaRcH tErMs"). Open as many sites as seem promising in new tabs.
5. Log into your local library site and search the catalog, or the associated
6. Now that you have an obnoxious amount of tabs open, it is time to start winnowing the field and deleting some options. Look at each site and determine whether it contains information relevant to your research. If it does not close out the tab
7. For the remainder of the sites, close any tab that does not pass the credibility/validity test.
8. Create a Source Document by copying and pasting all relevant information into a single document.
9. Create Chicago style citations for each source you plan on using
    a. End notes are the best for most historical research and papers
    b. Footnotes are acceptable if you are using Google Docs

SourceDoc Example

Credibility/Validity Score

- **Legitimacy of the Institution (Institution Score):**
- **Objectivity of the Source (Objectivity Score):**

- **1**: Highly reputable institution
- **0.5**: Mostly reputable, but with minor concerns
- **0**: Neutral or unknown institution
- **-0.5**: Somewhat unreliable, often biased or lacking credibility
- **-1**: Known for misinformation or clear bias

- **Author's Expertise (Expertise Score)**:
  - **1**: Author is an expert in the field
  - **0.5**: Author shows some expertise but lacks full credibility
  - **0**: Author has moderate expertise or is unclear
  - **-0.5**: Author lacks significant expertise, with some unreliable information
  - **-1**: Author has no relevant expertise or has a history of presenting false information

- **1**: Completely objective and balanced
- **0.5**: Mostly objective, with minor bias or omissions
- **0**: Neutral but lacks depth or multiple viewpoints
- **-0.5**: Somewhat biased, with an agenda or slant
- **-1**: Clearly biased, with a strong agenda

- **Intended Audience (Audience Score)**:
  - **1**: Aimed at an educated, critical audience
  - **0.5**: Aimed at a knowledgeable audience, but with some simplifications
  - **0**: Aimed at a general audience
  - **-0.5**: Aimed at an audience prone to bias or sensationalism
  - **-1**: Aimed at a sensationalist or conspiracy-driven audience

For each source, add the scores and divide by 4 to give an overall average. This score should go between the title and the citation in your SourceDoc

Episode 2: The Tree Tops (initial research)